



10 ♖a3

After 10 ♖d2 ♖f6 11 ♔c2 exd4! already Black is better because of White having played f2-f3.

10...a6! 11 ♖c2 ♖ge7 12 0-0 h5!?

With the threat of a possible ...h5-h4, exposing a weakness on the h2-b8 diagonal.

12...0-0 is a safer method of handling the position when Black does not need to fear an IQP because of the weaknesses created by f2-f3 and the open access down the e- and c-files for his rooks.

13 dxe5 ♖xe5 14 ♙xe5 ♙xe5 15 f4 ♙d6 16 ♖cd4 h4 17 ♔h1 ♖h6 18 b4?

Positionally very suspect as this will allow Black to secure the c4-square with a well-timed ...b7-b5.

18...♙f8!



Getting the king to safety. Black now has plans of controlling the e-file.

19 ♖d2 ♜e8 20 f5 ♘g8 21 ♗f4 ♗f6 22 ♜ac1 b5!

Black soon won in B.Gonzalez-K.Sasikiran, Mallorca Olympiad 2004.

C22) 9 dxe5 ♗xe5 10 0-0

With 10 ♗c2 White takes away the c2-square from the knight on b1. This means it is safe to develop the g8-knight to f6, as ♗a3-c2-e3-f5 is no longer an issue. After 10...♗f6 White cannot just play on the usual IQP rules of swapping minor pieces because he has weakened his kingside and Black has very active pieces. These two factors trump the weak d5-pawn. Here White might try:

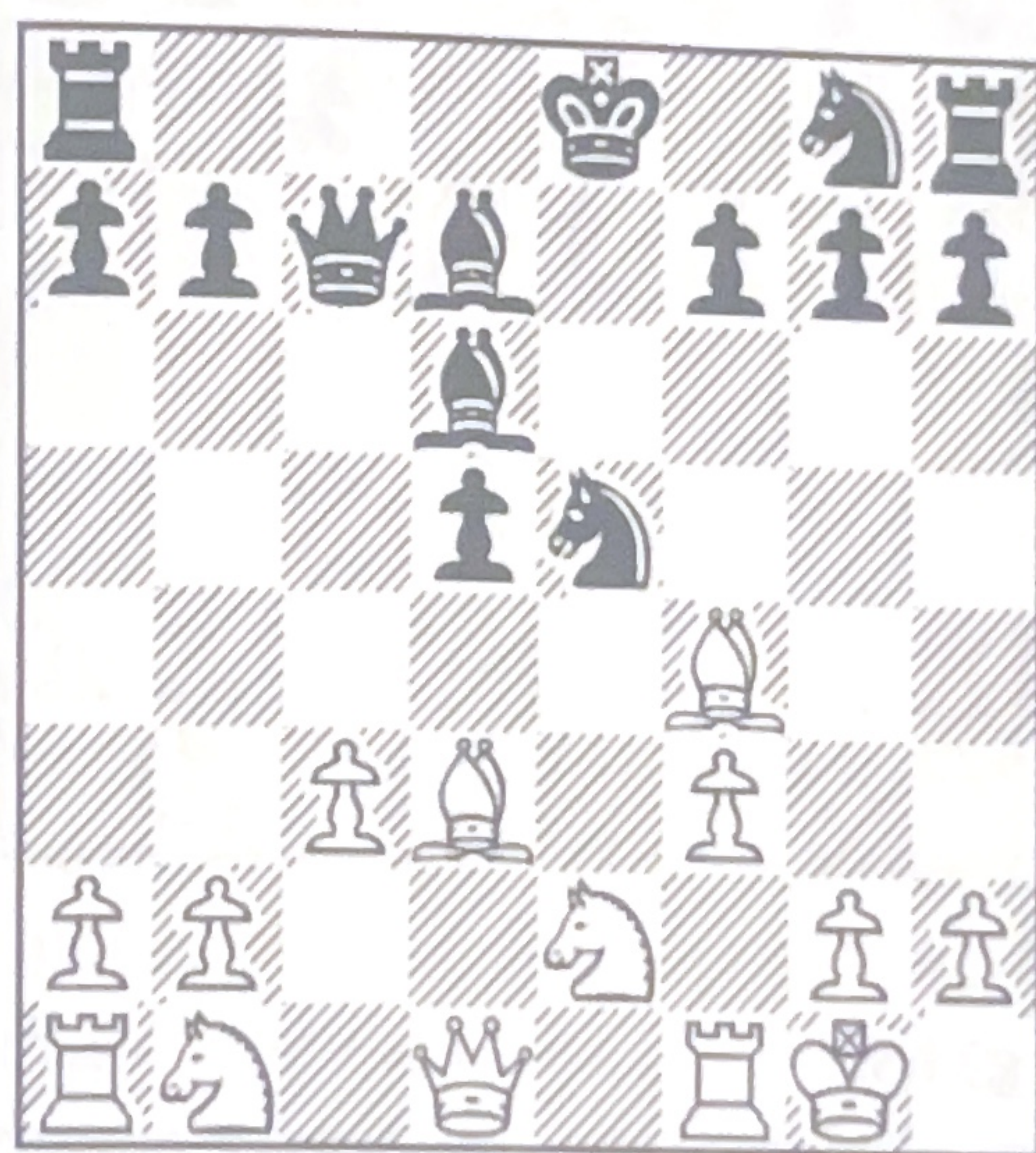
a) 11 ♗a4 ♗d6 12 ♗xd7+ ♜xd7 13 0-0 0-0 and now the developing move 14 ♗d2? is bad after the obvious 14...♗c5+ 15 ♗d4 ♗d3 when Black wins material.

b) 11 ♗b3 is a futile attempt at winning the d5-pawn: 11...♗c5 12 ♗xd5 0-0-0 and Black is much better.

c) 11 0-0 ♗d6 12 ♗a4 ♗c6 13 ♗d2 0-0 14 ♗g3 ♗h5 and Black is much better.

d) 11 ♗d2 ♗d6 12 0-0 0-0 13 ♗d4 ♗h5! 14 ♗g5? (the h2-pawn now becomes incredibly vulnerable) 14...h6 15 ♗h4 ♗g6 16 ♗xg6 ♗xh2+ 17 ♗h1 fxg6 and Black had won material in M.Passchyn-G.De Schampheleire, Geraardsbergen 2013.

10...♗d6



Now we have a final divide:

C221) 11 ♜e1

C222) 11 ♖h1

Other alternatives are:

a) After 11 ♗d4 Black must cover the f5-square with 11...♗e7! 12 ♗a3 (if 12 ♗b5 ♜b6+!) 12...a6 13 ♗ac2 0-0 14 ♗e3 ♜fe8! (all very natural moves so far) 15 ♜c2 h6 16 ♖h1 ♜b6 17 ♜ad1 ♗xd3 18 ♗xd6 ♗xb2 19 ♗xe7 ♗xd1 20 ♜xd1 ♜xe7 21 ♗xd5 ♜d8 by when he has all

the positional trumps, with the better pawn structure and minor piece.

b) 11 ♖a3 a6 and then:

b1) 12 c4? immediately challenges the centre, but this is just plain wrong: 12...dxc4 13 ♙xe5 ♙xe5 14 ♙xc4 ♙xh2+! (14...♙f6 15 ♙xe5 wasn't so accurate in M.Ragger-A.Rasmussen, Beijing (rapid) 2008) 15 ♚h1 b5 16 ♙e3 ♙e7 17 f4 ♙b6 and Black swings the queen over to h6 to defend the imprisoned bishop.

b2) 12 ♙xe5 ♙xe5 13 f4 ♙d6 14 ♙c2 ♙f6 15 ♙cd4 0-0! (15...0-0-0 was more double-edged in T.Galinsky-J.Houska, Oslo 2012) 16 ♙f5 ♙xf5 17 ♙xf5 g6 18 ♙c2 ♙b6+ and Black is much better.

b3) 12 ♙c2 ♙e7! (the knight is well placed here and very importantly covers the f5-square) 13 ♙cd4 0-0 14 ♙e1 ♙fe8 15 ♙g3 ♙ad8 16 ♙c2 ♙7g6 17 b3 ♙xd3 18 ♙xd3 h5 19 ♙xd6 ♙xd6 and again Black doesn't have any problems; he has good pieces to offset the weakness of the d-pawn.

C221) 11 ♙e1 ♙f6!? 12 ♙xe5 ♙xe5



13 f4 ♙d6 14 ♙d4+ ♙f8 15 g3 h5!

From apparently nowhere Black begins an aggressive operation, but if we investigate the position deeper we can see that this is not so surprising as the barrier of pawns protecting the king have advanced to vulnerable squares.

16 ♙d2 h4 17 ♙f1 hxg3 18 hxg3 g6 19 ♙f3 ♙h3 20 f5 ♙g7 21 ♙g2 g5 22 ♙e3 ♙h5

Black had a winning attack in I.Saric-T.Polak, Split 2005.

c222) 11 ♖h1



This is a relatively normal position. Black should simply respond to White's threats and prioritize getting his king to safety.

11... ♖e7 12 ♙c2

Instead, 12 ♖a3 a6 13 ♖c2 0-0 14 ♖ed4 ♜ac8 15 ♖e3 ♖xd3 16 ♙xd6 ♖xb2 17 ♜b3 ♙xd6 18 ♜xb2 b5 was equal in A.Semeniuk-A.Dreev, Russian Team Championship 1999, and after 12 ♙xe5 ♙xe5 13 ♖d2 0-0 14 f4 ♙f6 15 ♖f3 ♜ad8 16 ♖fd4 ♜fe8 17 ♜c2 h6 18 ♜ae1 ♖c6 there was too much pressure on the d4 point in A.Turzo-L.Eperjesi, Budapest 2010.

12... 0-0

Black should keep things simple.

13 ♖a3

If 13 ♖d2 Black should simply put the rooks on the open files and look for opportunities to place a knight on a good post or push ...h5-h4: for example, 13... ♜fe8 14 ♜e1 ♖7g6 15 ♙g3 ♜ad8 16 ♖d4 (16 ♖b3 allows 16... ♖c4) 16... a6 17 ♙f5 h5 18 ♙xg6 ♖xg6 19 ♙xd6 ♙xd6 20 ♖2b3 ♖e5 and a knight is bound for c4.

13... ♖7g6 14 ♙g3

14 ♜xd5 ♙c6 15 ♜b3 is rebuffed by 15... ♖xf4 16 ♖xf4 ♖xf3!.

14... ♜fe8!?